

RANK 10
INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT SHILLONG

NORTH-EAST'S GUIDING LIGHT

IIM Shillong is strengthening its connection with industry and the region while preparing managers who can think critically, make sound decisions, and lead people

BY **KRISHNA GOPALAN**

IIM SHILLONG IS for the seeker, dreamer, and leader in you." So says the B-school's website. The inspiration is not just the cool weather, rolling green hills, vibrant music culture, and scenic spots of this hill town. Its Director, Arun Mohan Sherry, says the B-school occupies a distinctive position in the country's management education landscape. "That's because of the intersection of academic excellence, a strong sense of place, and a commitment to responsible leadership," he says.

Being in the North-East comes with its own set of advantages. "It gives IIM Shillong a perspective that is uniquely Indian and inherently global. It provides an environment where students are encouraged to look beyond conventional business paradigms and appreciate the complex interplay between business, society, sustainability and development," says Sherry.

MAKING IT COUNT

IIM Shillong is aware that businesses today operate in a dynamic and disruptive environment impacted by AI, digital transformation, geopolitical shifts, changing consumer behaviour and, of course, new business models. "This means management education cannot remain static," says Sherry. The B-schools and industry will have to work in proximity. Sherry says IIM Shillong is working towards making the curriculum more "industry-responsive, interdisciplinary and experiential". The aim is more intensive engagement through live projects, executive education and leadership programmes. "We are placing greater emphasis on areas that are increasingly central to decision making—AI and analytics, digital transformation, entre-